

Data Classification & Handling Policy

Classification tiers and handling requirements (ID.AM, PR.DS)

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Purpose, Scope, and Authority

This policy is part of the BVTech Written Information Security Program, aligned to the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0. It applies to all BVTech LLC personnel, contractors, systems, and, where adopted by a client, the client's covered environment. The Managing Partner (or designated security officer) owns this policy, reviews it at least annually, and approves exceptions in writing. Violations may result in disciplinary action up to termination of employment or contract.

Exception process: submit written request describing the business need, compensating controls, and duration. Exceptions expire after 12 months unless renewed. NIST CSF 2.0 references shown per section (GV, ID, PR, DE, RS, RC).

Classification Tiers

Tier	Definition	Examples
Restricted	Legal/contractual protection required; severe harm if disclosed	Client credentials, PHI, payment data, security findings, backup encryption keys
Confidential	Business-sensitive; harm if disclosed	Client environment docs, contracts, pricing, internal financials, source code
Internal	Not for public release; limited harm	Procedures, internal comms, project plans
Public	Approved for public release	Marketing site content, published pricing pages

Handling Requirements

Requirement	Restricted	Confidential	Internal
Encryption in transit	Required	Required	Required
Encryption at rest	Required	Required	Recommended
Access	Named individuals, logged	Role-based, need-to-know	All staff
External sharing	Prohibited without contract + secure channel	Approved recipients, secure channel	Management approval
Storage locations	Vault / designated systems only	Approved business systems	Approved business systems
Disposal	Cryptographic erase / certified destruction	Secure deletion	Standard deletion

Rules of Thumb

- When unsure, classify one tier higher.
- Client data inherits at least Confidential; anything enabling access to client systems is Restricted.
- Never store Restricted data on personal devices or personal cloud accounts.